

## CHEF KARANN TALWAR

Chef Karann Talwar is the award-winning Head Chef and Managing Director at Kitchen Kraft Luxury Catering in New Delhi, India. Chef Talwar's archive of recipes has been enriched by his passion for food and years of in-depth research to bring the finest cuisine to the plates of his clients. A seasoned gourmet professional, he gained 15 years of experience in the food industry at *Bukhara* in ITC Maurya (New Delhi, India), ITC Grand Central (Mumbai, India), Grand Hyatt (Singapore), Hyatt Regency (Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia) and Carnival Cruise (USA).

### Education

Chef Talwar graduated from India's premier hotel management college - the Institute of Hotel Management in Mumbai, India with a specialisation in Catering Technology & Applied Nutrition after completing a B.Sc in Hospitality and Hotel Administration.

### Early Exposure

He believes in constantly learning and growing and has spent years developing his culinary skills. He completed training at The Taj Lands End, Mumbai and was a part of pre-opening team of the Indian restaurant "Masala Bay" followed it up with training in the Mumbai's Best Indian Restaurant, "Kandhar" in The Oberoi Hotels & Resorts, Mumbai.

### First Indian Kitchen Experience

Chef Talwar started his Indian food culinary journey with the WelcomGroup as a Management Trainee. He was a part of the Kitchen Executive Training Program - a prestigious and competitive program selecting only 10 Chefs annually.

Chef Talwar was in the limelight early on in his career. He was featured in the television show 1000 Places to See Before You Die on the Travel and Living channel. He was one of the first management trainees to be a part of such a show.

He even represented ITC WelcomGroup Hotels at the coveted 3rd EL CORDON BLEU- IFOWS CULINARY CUP, during the IFOWS-4TM India International Food & Wine Show.

Chef Talwar had the privilege of hosting a food festival tour with Chef Alan Bird from Michelin Star restaurant Ivy League in London, UK. He was part of the travelling team visiting 4 cities with Chef Bird crafting progressive British cuisine.

During this time, Chef Talwar was also involved in a Mexican food festival at the Mexican Embassy and was preparing meals and menus for global dignitaries, heads of states and world leaders.

Chef Talwar was an integral part of the catering team for the great Chattwal wedding, one of the most luxurious Indian weddings to ever happen in India.

He also participated in Food Fiesta, Qorma, Qaliya, Salan festival at the ITC Maurya Sheraton, New Delhi which had the best Indian chefs flown from all over India to cook recreations of century 'Old recipes from the royal courts of Hyderabad, Lucknow, Turkey and Egypt. He was awarded as the youngest Master Chef in Indian cuisine. This led him to a Sous Chef position at *Bukhara* in the ITC Hotel Maurya Sheraton & Towers, New Delhi, India. He worked closely with the head chef of the restaurant as his mentor.

*Bukhara* restaurant is world-renowned for its authentic Tandoor-cooked Indian dishes. Celebrities such as Bill Clinton and Bruce Springsteen have come here not just for the kababs but for the Raan, the famous Dal Bukhara, and Tandoori Chicken.

*Bukhara* was voted as the best Indian restaurant in Mumbai, 2007-2008 while Chef Talwar was the second-in-command there. He crafted menus as per guest requirements and suggestions, ensured hygiene standards were maintained at all times in the show kitchen and supporting kitchen and managed the daily operations of the kitchen.

Chef Talwar was the driving force behind the Clinton Platter and the Chelsea Platter. These were entirely designed by him.

The highlight of his time here was being awarded a recognition certificate from the CEO of ITC Hotels Limited for going the extra mile in ensuring guest satisfaction. This prestigious award is given to only 10 employees of the company every year.

## **International Exposure**

After mastering the art of Indian cuisine, Chef Talwar then moved to Hyatt Regency in Kuantan, Malaysia. He worked there as an Expat Indian Master Chef for the next two years. He spearheaded the opening of the first ever open kitchen restaurant - *Kampung* in Kuantan. The restaurant served fragrant and flavourful Indian cuisine. In his time there he assisted the executive chef in menu engineering, kitchen planning and workflow patterns in the kitchen. Conducted food sampling, product knowledge, and trial runs before the restaurant opening. He worked closely with cross-functional teams to ensure widespread marketing and increased profitability of the restaurant.

During the two years Chef Talwar was in Kuantan, he promoted Indian food in the region, featuring tandoori, tawa kebabs, Indian curries and various Indian breads and desserts. Always learning, he successfully completed the Hyatt on Skill Training Programme eventually becoming a certified Departmental Trainer. He was the first chef awarded the -"The Hystar"- A recognition programme for employees excelling at Guest Contact areas. He had mastered the art of smooth kitchen operations!

He split his time between Kuantan and the Mezze9, a 5-star restaurant in the Grand Hyatt, Singapore. The restaurant promotes conscious eating with quality-driven sustainable ingredients in an open kitchen that showcases the chef's culinary showmanship.

Before starting Kitchen Kraft Luxury Catering, Chef Talwar was the Head Chef of The Supper Club on Carnival Cruise Lines for 3 years. He was the first Indian Expat Chef hired by the Carnival Cruise Lines. In his time there, he ensured the smooth running of the kitchen at all times. He created menus for the restaurant and events on board like weddings, birthdays and corporate events. He sourced ingredients with the dietary requirements and preferences of guests in mind. He recruited, trained and supervised kitchen staff, maintained the cruise ship's 5-star hygiene rating by adhering to the health and safety and hygiene standards and ensured that the kitchen was clean and tidy at all times. He even got Indian tandoors installed in a new set of ships joining the Carnival Cruise fleets.

## **Entrepreneurship Journey**

Chef Talwar had a brief stint as Head Chef at Essar, Gurgaon, India the year before he started his entrepreneurship journey. During his time there, he designed attractive menus to match the guest preferences. He planned, cooked and presented delicious dishes to the highest standard while managing the kitchen staff to seamlessly manage the day-to-day running of the kitchen.

Chef Talwar designed a menu for the Paddock Club at the very first Vodafone Grand Prix in India. He led a team to prepare a sit-down dinner for over 400 guests and the event. Planning this dinner independently gave him the push he needed to start his very own business. This led

to the creation of Kitchen Kraft Luxury Catering.

Started in 2012, Kitchen Kraft Luxury Catering offers a bold, bespoke and flavoursome culinary experience for their discerning guests. Chef Talwar has redefined the catering experience as his entrepreneurial venture is synonymous with decadent and delectable one-of-a-kind menus.

Leveraging Chef Talwar's industry insights and culinary skills, Kitchen Kraft Luxury Catering offers the latest trends in fine-dining pre-plated food experiences and provides options for more creative choices in the food industry.

A diverse array of cuisines from progressive Pan Asian to progressive Indian fusion cuisine are offered to their illustrious clients and their guests. Their clients are spoiled for choice from mouth-watering chaats, a hearty grill bar, savoury charcuterie snacks, scrumptious wok stations, modern Mexican cuisine, luscious Italian fare to decadent Indian dessert stations. Each menu is crafted to fit the client's needs and preferences.

From grand corporate conclaves to fun themed parties, Kitchen Kraft Luxury Catering does everything with utmost panache and efficiency. It has come to be known as one of the leading food service management companies in India, backed by formidable resources and valuable systems. It celebrates food, family and friends with fantastic food and spectacular presentation.

Kitchen Kraft Luxury Catering has been featured in acclaimed magazines and publications including Vogue India, Delhi Times, Times Food & Nightlife, Wedding Vows and several more. Vogue India called Kitchen Kraft Luxury Catering the most trusted catering brand.

Kitchen Kraft Luxury Catering has won the award the Best Catering Company and Chef Talwar won the award for Best Chef in 2022-2023 by the Gourmet Fest. Kitchen Kraft Luxury Catering has been recognised and awarded as an excellent catering business by several more organisations including Times Hospitality, Bikaner House, and the GDGC Global Destination Expo.

Maharaj Lakshyaraj Singh Mewar (The Print of Udaipur) selected Kitchen Kraft Luxury Catering as the most trusted catering brand in India.

Kitchen Kraft Luxury Catering was featured as the trendiest wedding caterer in town by Band Baaja Bride on NDTV Prime.

Creating a distinguished experience for esteemed clients is this chef-turned-entrepreneur's priority at Kitchen Kraft Luxury Catering. Chef Talwar ensures that he makes his client's celebrations extraordinary with fantastic food and efficient service.

"Any profession needs commitment, but to be a chef you need passion that turns into an obsession." - Chef Karann Talwar.